

CURSOR

BUILDATHON

Project Submission Document

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Complete every section of this document for your Cursor Buildathon submission. Write clearly and directly — this document should stand on its own without the demo.

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Section 01

01

Project Overview

Project Name & One-Line Pitch

- State the project name
- One sentence — what it does, for whom, and the core value

Summary

- Three to five sentences covering the problem, the solution, and who uses it

Submission Details

- Track name and confirmation that the track technology is meaningfully integrated
- Team name, demo URL, and repository link

Section 02

02

Problem Statement

The Problem

- Specific problem being addressed — name who experiences it and in what context
- What the consequence is if left unsolved

Why It Matters

- Frequency and severity of the problem
- What people currently do as a workaround and why that falls short

Root Cause

- The underlying cause — not just the symptom

Section 03

03

Proposed Solution

What the Product Does

- Plain-language description of the product and how it works
- The core mechanism — what makes it actually function

Key Features

- List the core features that are built, working, and demonstrable
- For each feature, state what user need it addresses

Scope

- What is explicitly in scope for this build
- What was deliberately left out due to time constraints

Section 04

04 Functional Requirements

Write specific, testable requirements grouped by MoSCoW priority. Each requirement describes something the system can do.

Must Have

- Requirements without which the product does not function — all must be demonstrable in the live demo

Should Have

- Requirements that significantly improve the product but are not critical to the core experience

Could Have / Won't Have (This Build)

- Considered but not built — shows prioritisation and product thinking

Section 05

05 Non-Functional Requirements

Performance

- Expected response times for key interactions
- Behaviour under concurrent usage

Reliability & Error Handling

- How the system handles API failures, timeouts, and unexpected inputs
- Any fallback behaviour in place

Usability

- Design principles behind the interface
- Accessibility considerations

Scalability

- What would need to change to handle significantly more load
- Architectural decisions made with scale in mind

Section 06

06 Technical Architecture

System Overview

- High-level description of the architecture — components and how they communicate
- Include a diagram if possible

Technology Stack

- Every major technology used with a brief rationale for the choice
- Frontend, backend, AI/ML model, database, hosting, track technology, third-party APIs

Data Flow

- What happens — step by step — when a user performs the core action
- Include all external API calls, database interactions, and AI model invocations

AI Integration

- Model and provider used
- How it is prompted and what role it plays in the user experience

Known Technical Limitations

- Incomplete or unstable areas, mocked components, and deliberate technical debt

Section 07

07 Security

Authentication & Authorisation

- How users are authenticated — login system, session management, route protection
- Any role-based access control in place

Data Handling

- How user data is stored and whether any sensitive data is persisted
- Encryption or hashing applied to sensitive fields

API & Secret Management

- Confirmation that no API keys or secrets are exposed in the frontend or repository
- Where secrets are stored and how they are accessed at runtime

Input Validation

- How the system handles unexpected, malformed, or potentially malicious inputs
- Any sanitisation or validation logic on the backend

Known Vulnerabilities or Gaps

- Any security concerns not addressed in this build and the reason

Section 08

08 User Stories & Use Cases

Write in the format: As a [user], I want to [action], so that [outcome].

Core User Stories

- Five to ten stories covering the main ways someone uses the product

Primary Use Case Walkthrough

- Step-by-step trace of the most important user journey
- What the user does, what the system does, what the user sees at the end

Edge Cases

- How the system handles boundary conditions and unexpected user behaviour

Section 09

09 Target Users & Market

Primary User

- Who they are, their context, and the specific pain this product addresses for them

Market Opportunity

- Size of the problem space and the segment being targeted first

Competitive Landscape

- Two to three alternatives a user would consider today and the key weakness of each

Section 10

10 Business Model

Revenue Model

- The monetisation approach — SaaS, usage-based, freemium, marketplace, or other
- Why this model fits the product and the user

Pricing Hypothesis

- What users would pay and the reasoning behind it

Go-to-Market

- How the first ten customers would be acquired — channel, message, specific targets

Roadmap

- What exists now, what comes in 0–3 months, and what the product looks like in a year

Section 11

11 Why This Project Leads the Track

Make the case — directly and confidently — for why your project should be the track winner.

Technical Edge

- What your build does technically that others in the track are unlikely to match
- Depth of AI integration, architecture decisions, or engineering choices that stand out

Problem-Solution Fit

- Why your problem is worth solving and your solution is the right one
- The directness of the link between the problem and what you built

Execution Quality

- What the demo shows — stability, completeness, and polish relative to a 24-hour build

Real-World Potential

- Why this does not end at the hackathon — users, growth, and what comes next

Section 12

12 Team & Roles

Team Members

- Each person's name, their role on this project, and what they specifically built
- One line of relevant background per person

Why This Team

- The combination of skills or experience that makes this team right for this problem